

Trajectory Planning for Mission Completion Time Reduction in UAV-Assisted Data Collection in Wireless Sensor Networks

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Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) provide a flexible solution for data collection in wireless sensor networks (WSNs), especially when ground nodes (GNs) are deployed in wide or hard-to-access areas. Mission completion time (MCT) is an important performance metric in UAV-assisted data collection tasks. Existing studies have mainly focused on UAV flight trajectory planning to reduce mission completion time. But the data collection process also has a significant impact on MCT because the transmission rate varies with the distance between the UAV and GNs.

This thesis proposes a trajectory planning method for a single-UAV-assisted WSN data collection task. The proposed method first obtains a shortest geometric reference path that passes through the GN communication regions and uses this path as global directional guidance for local trajectory planning. For each GN, the UAV adjusts its data collection trajectory according to the required data amount. For adjacent GNs with overlapping communication regions, the proposed method further allows service switching within the overlap region to enable a more efficient transition to the next GN. Simulation results show that the proposed method outperforms the representative benchmark methods.

Keywords—UAV, mission completion time, wireless sensor networks, trajectory planning, data collection.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

With the rapid development of the Internet of Things (IoT) and wireless communication technologies, wireless sensor networks (WSNs) have been widely applied in environmental monitoring, smart agriculture, post-disaster detection, military reconnaissance, and other fields [1–3]. In these applications, ground nodes (GNs) are mainly responsible for collecting environmental parameters, such as temperature, humidity, air quality, and water quality. In such IoT applications, each GN usually generates lightweight data packets [4, 5]. However, due to limited battery capacity and hardware cost, GNs are often unable to support long-distance wireless transmission. Therefore, transmitting sensing data back to a data center remains a major challenge.

Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) have become a feasible solution to this problem because of their high mobility, flexible deployment, and ability to establish favorable air-to-ground (A2G) line-of-sight (LoS) communication links [6, 7]. A UAV can serve as an aerial mobile data collector by actively approaching GNs and collecting data within their communication regions. This approach not only reduces the transmission power

consumption of GNs and extends the lifetime of sensing devices, but also alleviates communication interruptions caused by terrain blockage [8,9].

In UAV-assisted data collection tasks, mission completion time (MCT) is a critical performance metric [10]. MCT refers to the total time required for the UAV to depart from the data center, complete data collection from all target GNs, and return to the data center. For time-sensitive IoT applications, such as real-time forest fire monitoring and border intrusion detection, reducing MCT allows the decision center to obtain on-site information more quickly and respond in a timely manner [11,12]. A shorter MCT also enables the UAV to serve more GNs within its limited battery [13]. Early studies often approximated MCT by the UAV flight time and simplified the problem into a flight distance reduction problem [14]. However, when communication models and data requirements are considered, a shortest geometric path does not necessarily lead to a shorter MCT [15,16]. According to the Shannon formula, the wireless transmission rate increases with the signal-to-noise ratio (SNR), while the SNR decreases as the communication distance between the UAV and a GN increases [17]. If the UAV passes near the boundary of a GN communication region to reduce flight distance, the flight time can be shortened, but the lower transmission rate can increase the data collection time or hovering time. In contrast, if the UAV moves excessively close to the GN center to improve the transmission rate, additional flight distance and flight time can be introduced. Therefore, reducing MCT requires a proper tradeoff between flight distance and data collection time.

Since the UAV only needs to enter the communication region of each GN to collect data and does not have to fly directly above every GN, this task can be regarded as a path planning problem with neighborhoods, namely the Traveling Salesman Prob-

lem with Neighborhoods (TSPN) [18]. However, unlike conventional TSPN, which mainly focuses on geometric path length, UAV-assisted data collection is also affected by communication distance, transmission rate, and data collection time. Therefore, the UAV needs to determine not only the visiting path among communication regions, but also the entry position, exit position, movement depth, and data collection trajectory within each communication region. Existing studies have investigated UAV-assisted WSN data collection from different perspectives. Some studies reduce the geometric path length through GN communication regions [18], while other studies consider flying mode, hovering mode, or V-shaped collection trajectories [19, 20]. These studies show that MCT is affected by both flight time and data collection time. Two issues still require further consideration. First, if global geometric direction information is not considered, local trajectory adjustment can deviate from the overall shorter flight path. Second, when adjacent GN communication regions overlap, restricting service switching to the boundary of a single communication circle can cause redundant boundary transitions and unnecessary back-and-forth movement.

Based on the above observations, this thesis focuses on a single-UAV-assisted WSN data collection task and proposes a trajectory planning method that considers both flight path and data collection efficiency. The proposed method combines global geometric information and a local data collection strategy to reduce the overall MCT of the UAV data collection task. The related mechanisms and implementation details are presented in the following chapters.

The main contributions of this thesis are summarized as follows.

1. A trajectory planning method is developed to reduce the MCT of UAV-assisted WSN data collection by considering both flight trajectory and data collection trajectory.
2. A global-direction-guided local trajectory adjustment method is introduced to keep local service trajectories close to the shortest geometric path and reduce unnecessary flight distance.
3. A flexible service switching strategy is developed for consecutive GNs with overlapping communication ranges, allowing the UAV to use shared coverage regions as switching areas and reduce redundant boundary transitions.
4. Simulation results show that the proposed method reduces the overall MCT compared with the benchmark methods under different data requirements and GN distributions.

The remainder of this thesis is organized as follows. Chapter 2 reviews related studies on trajectory planning for UAV-assisted WSN data collection. Chapter 3 introduces the system model. Chapter 4 describes the proposed trajectory planning method. Chapter 5 presents the simulation setup, and performance evaluation. Finally, Chapter 6 concludes this thesis and discusses possible future research directions.

Chapter 2

Related Work

In UAV-assisted WSN data collection tasks, existing studies can be broadly divided into two categories. The first category focuses on geometric path planning, where the communication range of each GN is regarded as a serviceable region, and the UAV flight path passing through all communication regions is shortened to reduce flight time. The second category considers the data collection process within the communication range, where the UAV adjusts its collection trajectory according to the required data amount and communication conditions. The former provides a shorter geometric reference path, whereas the latter reduces the data collection time.

The study in [18] modeled UAV path planning as a TSPN problem and showed that this problem is NP-hard. In [21] considered a single-UAV-assisted data collection problem by jointly considering trajectory, altitude, velocity, and link scheduling. The study indicated that data transmission can be supported when the UAV is located within the communication range of a ground user, without requiring the UAV to fly directly above the ground user. The original mission time problem was transformed into

a trajectory length problem. This method mainly focuses on shortening the geometric path length.

Reference [15] indicated that simply shortening the flight distance can move the UAV farther away from sensor nodes, thereby reducing the transmission rate and increasing the time required to complete data reception. The results show that the flight distance, flight speed, and communication rate in UAV data collection tasks are not independent and should be considered jointly. The effect of the collection point location on mission time was further discussed in [16], where it was shown that the UAV data collection point should not be determined solely by the shortest flight distance or the best communication quality. If the UAV flies directly above a node, better communication quality can be achieved, but the flight distance can increase. In contrast, if the UAV collects data near the boundary of the communication range, the flight path can be shortened, but the longer distance between the UAV and the node reduces the transmission rate and increases the data collection time. This observation suggests that the collection point location should be determined by jointly considering the flight cost and the communication condition.

In [19], FM and HM were introduced as two data collection modes for UAVs. In FM, the UAV can continuously receive data while flying, which is suitable for nodes with smaller data requirements or better communication conditions. In HM, the UAV hovers at a specific location for data collection, which is suitable for nodes with larger data requirements or poorer communication conditions. The distinction between FM and HM allows the UAV to adjust its collection mode according to the node status and data requirement, instead of serving all nodes with a fixed collection mode.

For user scheduling and UAV trajectory design, [22] investigated the completion time problem for a single UAV collecting data from multiple sensor nodes. It was proved that, under specific conditions, a suitable UAV trajectory has an SHF structure, in which the UAV hovers at selected locations for data collection and flies at the maximum speed between these hovering locations. The authors also emphasized the importance of segment-based scheduling, meaning that the UAV mainly serves a specific sensor during a particular flying or hovering segment instead of frequently switching among different sensors.

In [12] further investigated the impact of the data collection trajectory on the MCT and proposed a V-shaped collection trajectory. If the UAV flies into the interior of the communication range, part of the flight distance increases, but the SNR and transmission rate can be improved, thereby reducing the data collection time and the overall mission time. The work also pointed out that the service trajectories of adjacent nodes are coupled. The previous node affects the starting position when the UAV serves the next node. Therefore, if the service trajectory of each node is determined independently, additional flight distance can be introduced for subsequent nodes. In other words, locally reducing the data collection time of one node does not necessarily reduce the overall MCT. The UAV still needs to consider the continuous flight direction and service connection between adjacent nodes.

The above studies show that trajectory planning for UAV-assisted data collection mainly involves two interrelated design aspects. First, geometric path planning methods reduce the flight distance for the UAV to pass through multiple communication regions [18,21]. Second, data collection trajectory design indicates that the UAV can moderately move into the communication range according to the required data amount

and communication conditions, thereby improving the transmission rate and reducing the data collection time [12, 16]. In addition, existing studies have explained the close relationship between UAV flight behavior and communication conditions from the perspectives of flight speed and transmit power control, as well as FM/HM mode switching [15, 19, 22].

Based on the above research context, this thesis focuses on a single-UAV-assisted WSN data collection task and investigates how to jointly consider the flight trajectory, the data collection trajectory within the communication range, and the service connection between adjacent nodes. Existing studies have shown the importance of geometric path shortening and data collection within the communication range. If trajectory planning mainly relies on geometric path length, the effect of the distance variation between the UAV and the GN on the data collection time cannot be fully reflected. In contrast, if the local data collection trajectory lacks a global geometric direction reference, the trajectory can gradually deviate from the shorter overall flight direction. In addition, when the communication ranges of adjacent or consecutive nodes overlap, the overlapping region provides additional flexibility for service switching. Effectively using this geometric property can help reduce unnecessary boundary switching and back-and-forth flight. Therefore, this study focuses on maintaining a shorter overall flight distance while considering the data collection efficiency within the communication range, and further utilizes the overlapping regions between adjacent communication ranges to improve service switching flexibility, thereby reducing the overall MCT.

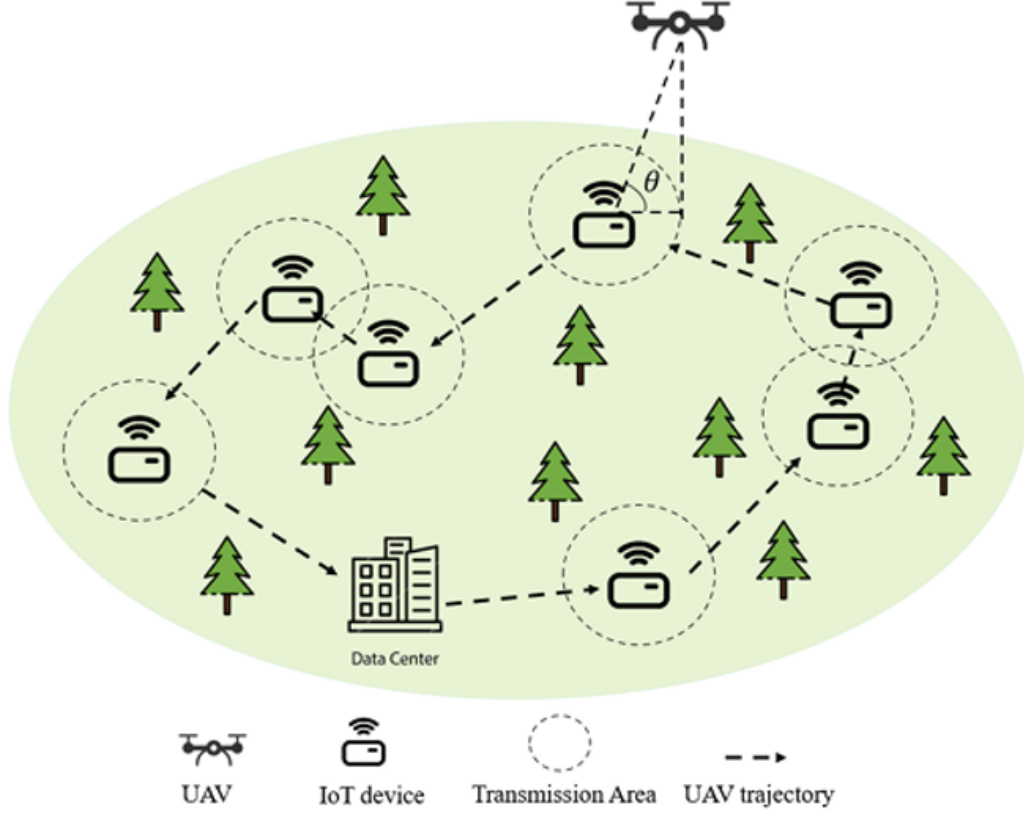
Chapter 3

System Model

3.1 System Model

As shown in Fig. 3.1, this thesis considers a UAV-assisted wireless sensor network in which a single UAV is employed to collect data from multiple ground nodes (GNs). The UAV departs from the data center, visits the communication regions of the GNs to collect their data, and returns to the data center after completing the data collection task. Let $\mathcal{N} = \{g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n\}$ denote the set of GNs, where n is the number of GNs. A three-dimensional Cartesian coordinate system is adopted, where the GNs are located on the ground plane and the UAV flies at a fixed altitude H . The elevation angle between the UAV and a GN is denoted by θ , and the maximum flying speed of the UAV is denoted by $v_{\max}$.

During the data collection process, the UAV may operate in flying mode (FM) or hovering mode (HM). In FM, the UAV collects data while moving within the communication region of a GN. In HM, if the data collected along the flying trajectory is insufficient, the UAV hovers directly above the corresponding GN for additional data collection.



圖一：無人機收集資料示意圖

Figure 3.1: Illustration of the UAV data collection process.

1) *Transmission Model*: A delay-tolerant UAV-assisted WSN is considered, in which each ground node g_i stores sensing data and uploads the data to the UAV when the UAV enters its communication region. Each ground node is equipped with a single omnidirectional antenna and transmits with a fixed power P_t over a channel bandwidth B . The uplink transmission rate from GN g_i to the UAV at time t is expressed as

$$R_i(t) = B \log_2 (1 + \gamma_i(t)) \quad (3.1)$$

in which $\gamma_i(t)$ denotes the received signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) from GN g_i to the UAV at time t . The SNR is given by

$$\gamma_i(t) = \frac{P_t}{\sigma^2 L_{dB_i}(t)} \quad (3.2)$$

where σ^2 denotes the noise power at the UAV receiver, and $L_{dB_i}(t)$ represents the air-to-ground path loss between GN g_i and the UAV at time t . The UAV can successfully collect data only when the received SNR satisfies $\gamma_i(t) \geq \bar{\gamma}$. To avoid transmission interference among ground nodes, only the ground node being served is allowed to transmit data to the UAV during its corresponding service interval.

3.2 Problem Formulation

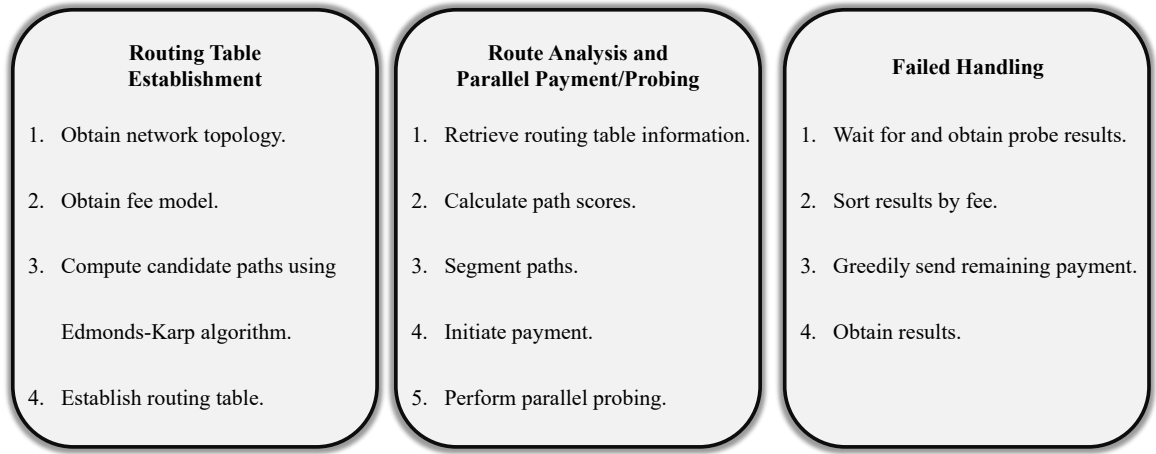


Figure 4.1: Flow chart of the system.

Chapter 4

Proposed Solution

This chapter provides a detailed explanation of the routing algorithm designed for PCN. The algorithm consists of three components: Routing Table Establishment, Route Analysis and Parallel Payment and Probing, and Failed Handling. The complete system architecture is illustrated in Figure 4.1.

TABLE 4.1: List of Notations

Symbol	Description
p	A specific path in the payment network
p_i	An individual path (often indexed, e.g., $p_1, p_2, \dots$)
$Y(p)$	Capacity of path p
A	Total transaction amount to be split
A_i	Amount of the transaction allocated to path p_i
k	Maximum number of paths to use for splitting, or number of top paths to probe
$\mathcal{P}$	Set of all candidate paths for the transaction
$\mathcal{S}$	Subset of currently selected paths from $\mathcal{P}$
$\text{TotalFee}(p)$	Total forwarding cost for path p
$\alpha_{[v_i, v_j]}$	Base fee for channel (v_i, v_j)
$\beta_{[v_i, v_j]}$	Fee rate for channel (v_i, v_j)
G	The current state of the network graph
A_{rem}	Remaining transaction amount that needs to be paid
$\mathcal{R}$	Set of successful probing results, each containing a path p_i and its confirmed capacity $Y(p_i)$
γ	Splitting threshold

4.1 Notation and Definitions

Table 4.1 lists the primary symbols used throughout the proposed routing algorithm.

These notations are essential for the detailed operations in each phase.

4.2 Routing Table Establishment

This study assumes that each node within the Payment Channel Network (PCN) can acquire the overall network topology and initial channel capacities via the gossip protocol. In the initial phase of the system, a routing table is constructed for each node by executing the candidate path computation process defined in Algorithm 1.

To discover multiple candidate paths to each destination node v_d (where $v_d \neq v_s$), this study proposes a breadth-first search (BFS)-based edge-disjoint path computation algorithm. The algorithm first initializes a residual graph based on the original channel capacities $c_{[v_i, v_j]}$, and then repeatedly performs BFS to identify feasible paths from the source node v_s to v_d .

Algorithm 1: Candidate Path Computation from Node v_s

Input:

Payment channel graph $G = (V, E)$;

Channel capacities $c_{[v_i, v_j]}$, fees $\alpha_{[v_i, v_j]}$, $\beta_{[v_i, v_j]}$;

Source node v_s .

Output:

Edge-disjoint candidate paths $\{\mathcal{P}_{v_s \rightarrow v_d} \mid v_d \in V, v_d \neq v_s\}$.

Definition:

$\mathcal{P}_{v_s \rightarrow v_d}$: Set of edge-disjoint candidate paths from v_s to v_d .

G^{res} : Residual graph with updated capacities after each path discovery.

p : A path from v_s to v_d , found via BFS.

TotalFee(p) = $\sum_{(v_i, v_j) \in p} \alpha_{[v_i, v_j]} + \beta_{[v_i, v_j]} \cdot A$: Forwarding cost of p for amount A .

```

1 foreach  $v_d \in V, v_d \neq v_s$  do
2   Initialize residual graph  $G^{res}$  with capacities  $c_{[v_i, v_j]}$ 
3    $\mathcal{P}_{v_s \rightarrow v_d} \leftarrow \emptyset$ 
4   while a path  $p$  exists from  $v_s$  to  $v_d$  in  $G^{res}$  via BFS do
5     Let  $p = \{v_s, \dots, v_d\}$ 
6      $Y(p) \leftarrow \min\{c_{[v_i, v_j]} \mid (v_i, v_j) \in p\}$ 
7     if  $Y(p) > 0$  then
8        $A \leftarrow Y(p)$ 
9        $\alpha(p) \leftarrow \sum_{(v_i, v_j) \in p} \alpha_{[v_i, v_j]}$ 
10       $\beta(p) \leftarrow \sum_{(v_i, v_j) \in p} \beta_{[v_i, v_j]}$ 
11      Add  $(p, A, \alpha(p), \beta(p))$  to  $\mathcal{P}_{v_s \rightarrow v_d}$ 
12      foreach  $(v_i, v_j) \in p$  do
13         $c_{[v_i, v_j]} \leftarrow c_{[v_i, v_j]} - A$ 
14         $c_{[v_j, v_i]} \leftarrow c_{[v_j, v_i]} + A$ 
15      else
16        Identify bottleneck edge  $(v_b, v'_b)$  on  $p$  with minimal capacity
17        Set  $c_{[v_b, v'_b]} \leftarrow 0$  in  $G^{res}$ 
18      Remove all edges  $(v_i, v_j)$  from  $G^{res}$  where  $c_{[v_i, v_j]} \leq 0$ 
19 return  $\{\mathcal{P}_{v_s \rightarrow v_d} \mid v_d \in V, v_d \neq v_s\}$ 

```

Once a path p is identified, the algorithm calculates the maximum transferable amount $Y(p)$ along the path, which is defined as the minimum residual capacity among all edges on the path. If $Y(p) > 0$, the algorithm further computes the total base fee and total fee rate along the path, and then stores the path along with its attributes as a candidate path.

The residual graph is subsequently updated based on $Y(p)$. The capacity of each forward edge is reduced by $Y(p)$, while the capacity of the corresponding reverse edge is increased by $Y(p)$ to support potential backward transmissions. If $Y(p) = 0$, the algorithm identifies the bottleneck edge and removes it from the residual graph to facilitate the discovery of alternative paths.

4.3 Phase I: Routing Analysis with Concurrent Payment and Probing

4.3.1 Path Scoring

The algorithm proposes a composite scoring function to prioritize candidate paths for a given transaction request. Each path p is evaluated based on three criteria: channel capacity, transaction fee, and channel usage frequency. The scoring function is defined as follows:

$$\text{Score}(p) = \alpha \cdot \widetilde{Y(p)} - \beta \cdot \widetilde{F(p)} - \gamma \cdot \widetilde{U(p)} \quad (4.1)$$

where:

- $\widetilde{Y(p)}$ is the normalized maximum payable amount along path p (i.e., normalized $Y(p)$);

- $\widetilde{F}(p)$ is the normalized total forwarding fee to send amount A along p , computed as $\sum_{(v_i, v_j) \in p} (\alpha_{[v_i, v_j]} + \beta_{[v_i, v_j]} \cdot A)$;
- $\widetilde{U}(p)$ is the normalized maximum usage frequency among all channels on path p , defined as $\max_{(v_i, v_j) \in p} U_{[v_i, v_j]}$;
- α, β, γ are user-defined weighting parameters that control the trade-off between capacity, fee, and congestion.

Each candidate path is assigned a score utilizing Equation 4.1. All paths are subsequently sorted in descending order of their scores. The top-ranked paths are preferred for subsequent payment and probing procedures.

4.3.2 Channel Usage Frequency Update Mechanism

To quantify the usage frequency of each channel, as referenced in the path scoring model, each node within the system locally maintains historical records of its owned channels. Whenever a channel (u, v) is utilized for a transaction, the node updates its usage frequency based on the elapsed time since its last usage. Specifically, an *Exponentially Weighted Moving Average (EWMA)* is applied to emphasize recent activity and to adapt to temporal usage dynamics.

This mechanism enables the system to reflect the real-time activeness of each channel and to incorporate such information into routing decisions. The frequency update procedure is formally described in Algorithm 2.

4.3.3 Trusted Nodes for Real-Time Channel State Inquiry

To enhance the timeliness and accuracy of channel state information, the proposed system introduces the concept of *trusted nodes*. A trusted node refers to a counterparty

Algorithm 2: Update Usage Frequency of Channel $U_{[v_i, v_j]}$

Input:Channel (v_i, v_j) ;EWMA update parameter $\lambda \in (0, 1)$ **Output:**Updated $U_{[v_i, v_j]}$ and last-used timestamp**Definition:** $U_{[v_i, v_j]}$: Estimated usage frequency of channel (v_i, v_j) based on Exponentially Weighted Moving Average (EWMA). $last_used_{[v_i, v_j]}$: The last time channel (v_i, v_j) was used. λ : Smoothing factor for EWMA, balancing recent usage and historical average.

```
1  $now \leftarrow$  current system time
2 if channel  $(v_i, v_j)$  was previously used then
3    $\Delta t \leftarrow now - last\_used_{[v_i, v_j]}$ 
4   if  $\Delta t > 0$  then
5      $U_{[v_i, v_j]} \leftarrow \lambda \cdot \frac{1}{\Delta t} + (1 - \lambda) \cdot U_{[v_i, v_j]}$ 
6 else
7    $U_{[v_i, v_j]} \leftarrow 1$  // Initialize on first use
8  $last\_used_{[v_i, v_j]} \leftarrow now$ 
```

that has exhibited a frequent transaction history with the sender. In practice, the trusted nodes may be individuals or merchants with whom the user has established trust, such as friends, family, or business partners.

The system offers an API interface that enables the sender to query trusted nodes in real-time for up-to-date information regarding the residual capacity and usage frequency of specific payment channels. This mechanism complements the static topology disseminated through the gossip protocol. Routing decisions can be made by the more updated information.

By leveraging trusted nodes, the sender can enhance the quality of path selection and traffic distribution. Payment success rates and overall routing efficiency can be improved.

4.3.4 Adaptive Multi-Path Payment Splitting Mechanism

An adaptive multi-path splitting mechanism is designed to efficiently allocate payment amounts across multiple paths, as presented in Algorithm 3. The algorithm

Algorithm 3: Adaptive Multi-Path Payment Splitting

Input:Candidate paths $\mathcal{P} = \{p_1, p_2, \dots\}$ with capacities $Y(p)$;Transaction amount A ;Minimum success rate threshold θ ;Maximum path count k **Output:**Split amounts $\{A_i \mid p_i \in \mathcal{S}\}$ **Definition:** θ : Minimum success rate threshold for path selection $\mathcal{S}$: Subset of selected paths from $\mathcal{P}$ T : Total capacity of the currently selected paths in $\mathcal{S}$ ρ : Minimum remaining capacity ratio among selected paths

```
1 Initialize  $\mathcal{S} \leftarrow \{p_1\}$ 
2 while True do
3    $T \leftarrow \sum_{p_i \in \mathcal{S}} Y(p_i)$ 
4   if  $T = 0$  then
5     raise error: insufficient capacity
6   foreach  $p_i \in \mathcal{S}$  do
7      $A_i \leftarrow A \cdot \frac{Y(p_i)}{T}$ 
8    $\rho \leftarrow \min_{p_i \in \mathcal{S}} \left( \frac{Y(p_i) - A_i}{Y(p_i)} \right)$ 
9   if  $\rho \geq \theta$  or  $|\mathcal{S}| = |\mathcal{P}|$  or  $|\mathcal{S}| = k$  then
10    break
11  Add next path  $p_j$  to  $\mathcal{S}$ 
12 return  $\{A_i \mid p_i \in \mathcal{S}\}$ 
```

dynamically assigns portions of the total payment to candidate paths based on their maximum transferable capacities. The algorithm also ensures that the minimum success rate among the selected paths does not fall below the system-defined threshold θ .

4.3.5 Path Probing and Payment Execution Procedure

Algorithm 4 outlines the procedure for executing payment transfers and initiating path probing. The system first attempts to transmit the segmented payment amounts through the initially selected paths.

Subsequently, the system evaluates the remaining unutilized candidate paths, ranks them based on their total forwarding fees that comprise both fixed and proportional

Algorithm 4: Path Probing and Payment Execution

Input:
Candidate paths $\{(p, Y(p), \alpha(p), \beta(p))\}$ sorted by preference;
Assigned split amounts $\{A_i\}$ for selected paths

Output:
Payment status (success/failure), total fee

Definition:
 $\alpha(p)$: Base fee for path p (sum of base fees of channels in p)
 $\beta(p)$: Fee rate for path p (sum of fee rates of channels in p)
 $\mathcal{C}$: Set of remaining unselected candidate paths
 τ : Timeout parameter for probing task
ProbeTask(p, τ): A task to probe path p with timeout τ

// Step 1: Execute payment on selected paths

- 1 **foreach** (p_i, A_i) *in selected paths* **do**
- 2 Attempt to transfer A_i through p_i

// Step 2: Probe additional candidate paths by fee

- 3 Let $\mathcal{C} \leftarrow$ remaining unselected candidate paths
- 4 Sort $\mathcal{C}$ by total forwarding cost:

$$\text{TotalFee}(p) = \sum_{(v_i, v_j) \in p} \alpha_{[v_i, v_j]} + \beta_{[v_i, v_j]} \cdot A$$

- 5 Let $\mathcal{C}_{top} \leftarrow$ top k paths with lowest total fee in $\mathcal{C}$
- 6 **foreach** $p \in \mathcal{C}_{top}$ **do**
- 7 Create and enqueue probing task ProbeTask(p, τ)

// Step 3: Finalize payment result

- 8 **if** *channel capacity is sufficient* **then**
- 9 Mark task as successful; compute total fee
- 10 **else**
- 11 Mark task as failed due to insufficient capacity
- 12 **return** *Payment status and total fee*

components. The top- k paths with the lowest forwarding fees are selected and issued as probing tasks to collect up-to-date information on channel availability.

Finally, if the payment is successfully completed via the initially selected paths, the task will be designated as successful and the total incurred fees will be calculated. Conversely, if the available capacity is insufficient, the task will be designated as failed and the subsequent retry mechanism for failed payments will be proceeded.

4.4 Phase II: Failed Handling

Algorithm 5 introduces the fallback mechanism that is invoked after the failure of the initial routing attempt. The system utilizes previously collected probing results to

identify alternative paths with sufficient capacity. For each probed path, a threshold is applied to the probed capacity to reduce the likelihood of failure during reattempts. Based on this threshold-adjusted capacity, the system allocates the remaining unpaid amount across eligible fallback paths.

Each selected fallback path subsequently executes the payment. If the entire remaining amount is successfully transferred via these paths, the payment task will be designated as success. If only a portion of the amount is transferred, the entire transaction will be defined as failure.

Algorithm 5: Fallback Routing Using Probed Paths

Input:

Remaining amount A_{rem} ;
Probing results $\mathcal{R} = \{(p_i, Y(p_i))\}$;
Splitting threshold γ ;
Network graph G and current payment task

Output:

Updated payment task (success/failure), total fee

Definition:

Current payment task: The overall payment operation being processed

$\mathcal{F}$: List of fallback paths chosen for payment, each with an assigned amount (p, A_s)

A_c : Current remaining capacity/amount to fulfill from A_{rem}

A_s : Amount to be sent through a specific fallback path p

success: Boolean variable indicating the overall success of fallback routing

fee_{total} : Accumulative total fee incurred for successful transfers

```
1 Initialize  $\mathcal{F} \leftarrow []$ 
2  $A_c \leftarrow A_{rem}$  // Remaining amount to fulfill
3 foreach  $(p, Y(p)) \in \mathcal{R}$  do
4   if  $A_c \leq 0$  then
5     break // Target amount fulfilled
6    $A_s \leftarrow \min(A_c, Y(p) \cdot (1 - \gamma))$  // Apply success margin
7   if  $A_s > 0$  then
8     Append  $(p, A_s)$  to  $\mathcal{F}$ 
9      $A_c \leftarrow A_c - A_s$ 
10 if  $\mathcal{F}$  is empty then
11   Mark payment task as failed; no feasible fallback paths
12 else
13   success  $\leftarrow$  True,  $fee_{total} \leftarrow 0$ 
14   foreach  $(p, A_s) \in \mathcal{F}$  do
15     if transfer of  $A_s$  through  $p$  is successful then
16       Update network state;  $fee_{total} += \text{TotalFee}(p)$ 
17     else
18       success  $\leftarrow$  False; break // Transfer failed, stop further attempts
19   if success and  $A_c \leq 0$  then
20     Mark payment task as successful; return  $fee \leftarrow fee_{total}$ 
21   else if success and  $A_c > 0$  then
22     Mark payment as partially successful; update  $A_{rem} \leftarrow A_c$ 
23   else
24     Mark payment task as failed; preserve  $A_{rem}$ 
```

Chapter 5

Performance Evaluation

The evaluation of the system was performed on Python 3.12.3 running on an AMD Ryzen 5 3600 CPU. A network comprising 100 nodes was generated using the Barabasi-Albert model [?], with the average node degree configured to 5. The channel capacity for each channel was set using the data from bitcoinvisuals.com [?]. Channel transaction fees were generated based on the average fee values and median values provided by 1ml.com [?]. For transaction amounts, this study sampled credit card transaction amounts from the Credit Card Fraud Detection dataset [?]. Transaction partner combinations were generated with the research data from Flash [?]. This approach aimed to simulate realistic transaction patterns. Regarding the simulator setup, this system employed Poisson distribution simulations to randomly generate transaction arrival times for various transaction frequencies (TPS). The single-hop latency in the experiment was set to 30 ms, referencing Deter-Pay [?]. Additionally, transactions were enabled to execute concurrently.

TABLE 5.1: Simulation Parameters

Parameter	Value
Number of Nodes	100
Number of Channels	521
Average Channel Capacity	8,929,583 satoshis
Median Channel Capacity	1,589,612 satoshis
Transaction Frequency (TPS)	10—100
Transaction Amount Range	0.0—25,691.16 USD
Simulation Duration	30—60 s
Single-hop Latency	30 ms

5.1 Comparison Algorithms

1. **Shortest Path:** Shortest path routing is currently employed in the Lightning Network to determine the path between senders and receivers for payments.
2. **Flash** [?]: Flash differentiates between high-value ???elephant??? payments and low-value ???mice??? payments. The strategy can improve success rates.
3. **Deter-Pay** [?]: Deter-Pay combines precomputed candidate paths with a probing-based balance reservation mechanism.

5.2 Performance Under Different Workloads

The experiment aims to verify the algorithm’s comprehensive performance under varying transaction frequencies. The experimental setup configures the transaction frequency per second from 10 TPS to 100 TPS. The transaction success rate, execution time, and transaction fees incurred per satoshi are recorded with the varying frequencies.

Transaction Success Rate: Figure 5.1 illustrates the variation in transaction success rate as the workload (TPS) increases. The proposed method consistently outperforms other protocols, including Deter-Pay, Flash, and Shortest Path, with all tested work-

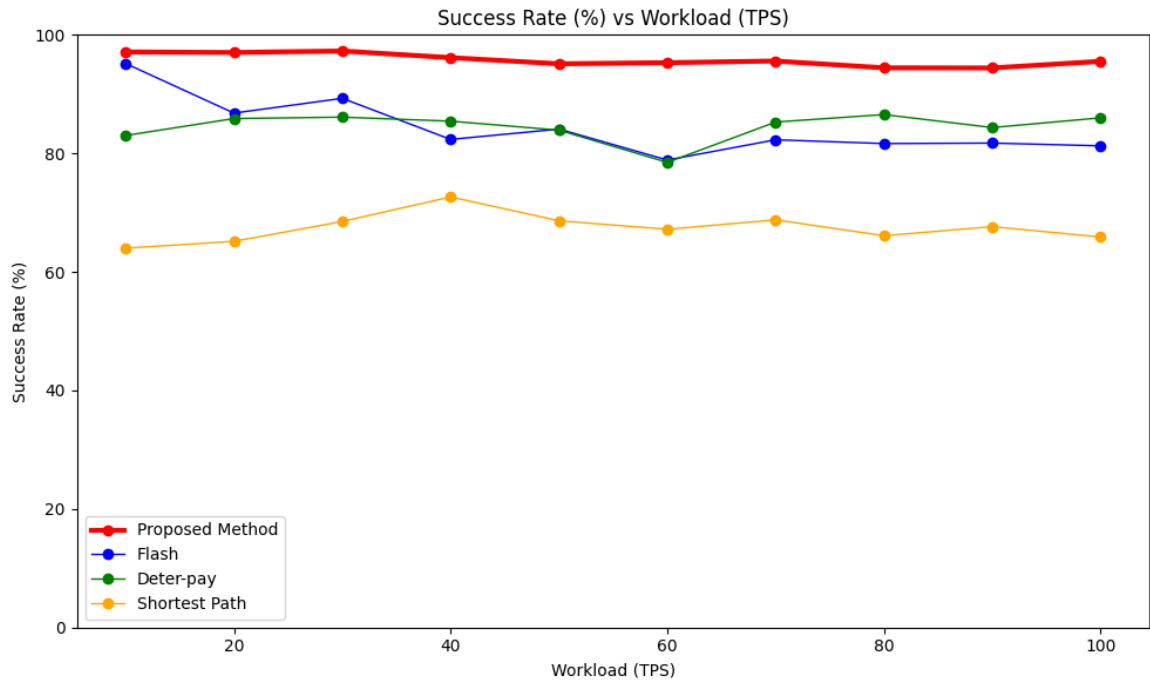


Figure 5.1: Success rate under different workloads.

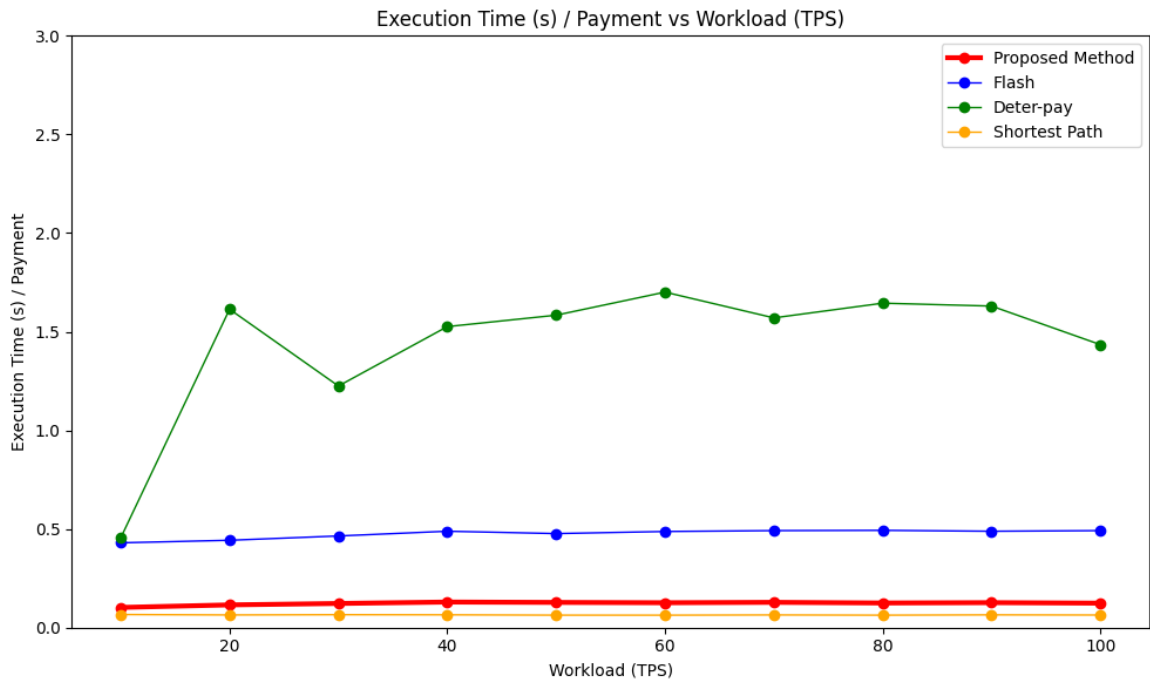


Figure 5.2: Execution time under different workloads.

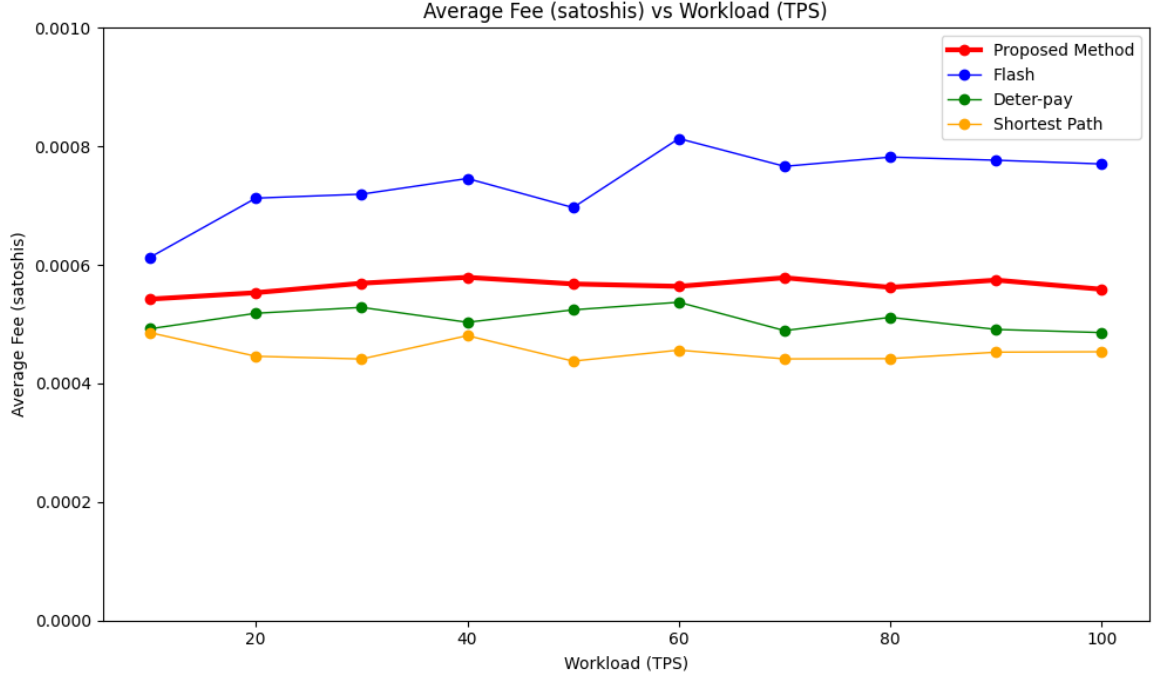


Figure 5.3: Transaction fees under different workloads.

loads. The method achieves the highest success rate even at a transaction frequency of 100 TPS and demonstrates its efficiency under high-load conditions. In contrast, Deter-Pay and Flash exhibit fluctuating or declining success rates as the workload increases, and Shortest Path consistently has the lowest performance among all evaluated methods.

Transaction Latency: Figure 5.2 displays the variation in transaction delay with different transaction workload frequencies. Compared to Deter-Pay and Flash, the proposed method exhibits stable and comparatively lower execution times. Shortest Path that depends solely on the most basic shortest path algorithm based on network topology, achieves the highest execution efficiency. The proposed method employs a two-phase payment process. A successful first payment phase can reduce overall transaction delay. Deter-Pay’s requirement for path probing and channel reservation contributes to its higher transaction delay, especially as higher transaction frequen-

cies may necessitate multiple probing and reservation attempts. Flash exhibits lower latency than Deter-Pay, but the method may incur higher delays due to repeated attempts. Flash lacks effective adaptation because of prior failures.

Transaction Fees: Figure 5.3 illustrates the variation in transaction fees under different transaction workloads. The proposed method incurs slightly higher fees than Deter-Pay but demonstrates a significant fee advantage over Flash. Shortest Path consistently yields the lowest transaction fees. The result is attributed to its reliance on a single path and a short hop count.

5.3 Performance with Scaled Capacities

Currently, the average channel capacity of the Lightning Network is approximately 900,000 Satoshis. As off-chain payments become more widespread and more PCNs are practically deployed, channel capacities are expected to increase. This experiment was conducted to verify the effectiveness of the proposed method in the future development of payment channels. The simulation was examined with channel capacities scaled from one-fold to tenfold. These simulations were performed with a fixed testing duration and a constant transaction frequency.

Figure 5.4 illustrates that the transaction success rates of all routing methods increase with the enhancement of channel capacity. Under conditions of increased channel capacity, the proposed method demonstrates a significant lead over Deter-Pay and Shortest Path methods.

Figure 5.5 indicates a gradual reduction in the execution time of the proposed method as channel capacity increases. This reduction is attributed to the increased likelihood of successful transactions in the algorithm's first payment phase with the

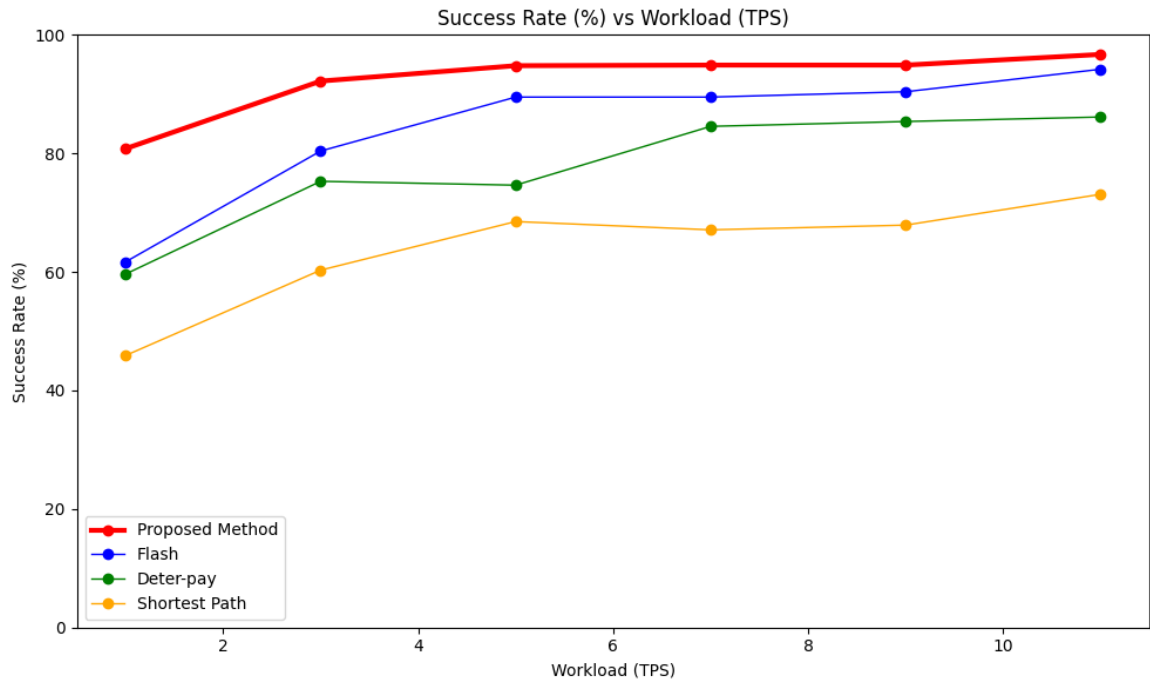


Figure 5.4: Success rate under different channel sizes.

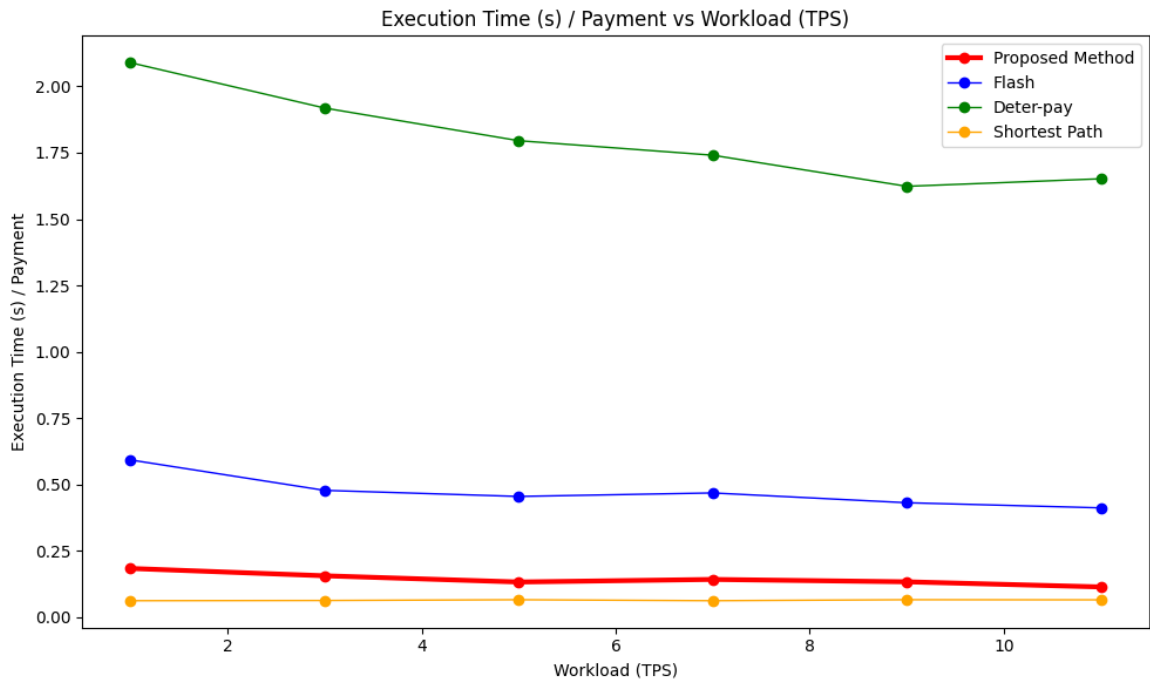


Figure 5.5: Execution time under different channel sizes.

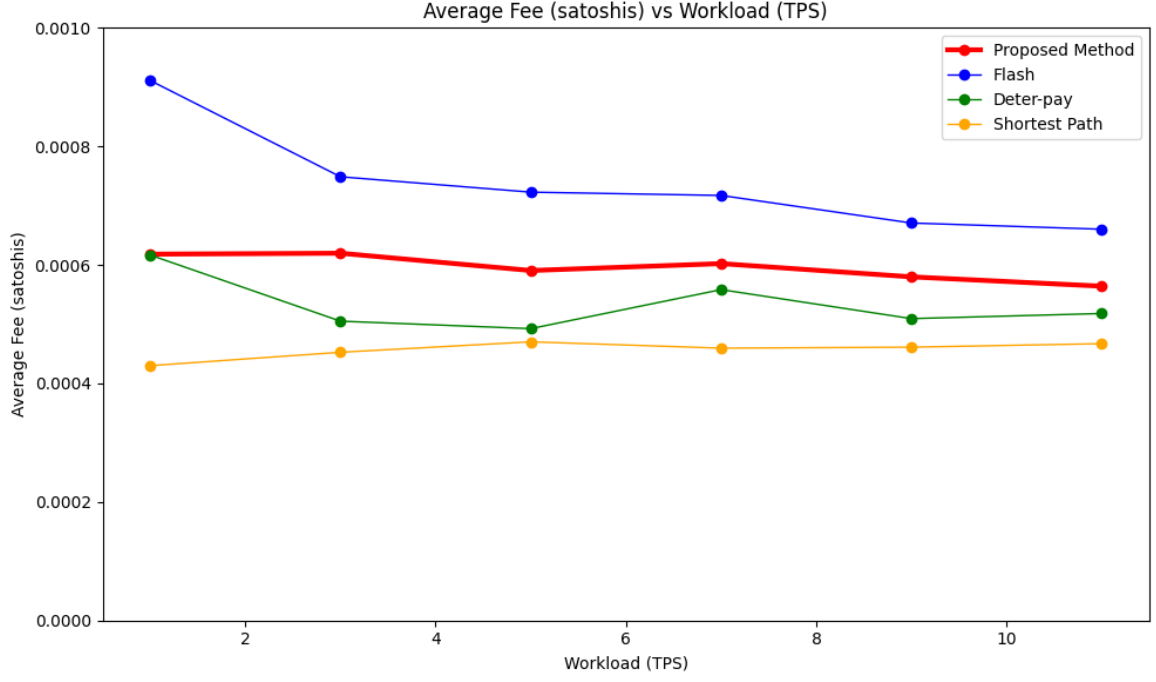


Figure 5.6: Transaction fees under different channel sizes.

larger channel capacity. Path score calculation and transaction splitting are used to achieve this success. This approach reduces the need for second-stage failed handling and consequently lowers transaction delay. In terms of transaction delay, the algorithm exhibits a more significant advantage compared to Deter-Pay and Flash.

Finally, regarding transaction fees, Figure 5.6 shows that the proposed method offers a lower fee advantage compared to Flash. Although its fees are higher than those of Deter-Pay and Shortest Path, the method demonstrates a significant advantage in success rate. The algorithm effectively balances success rate, execution time, and transaction fees.

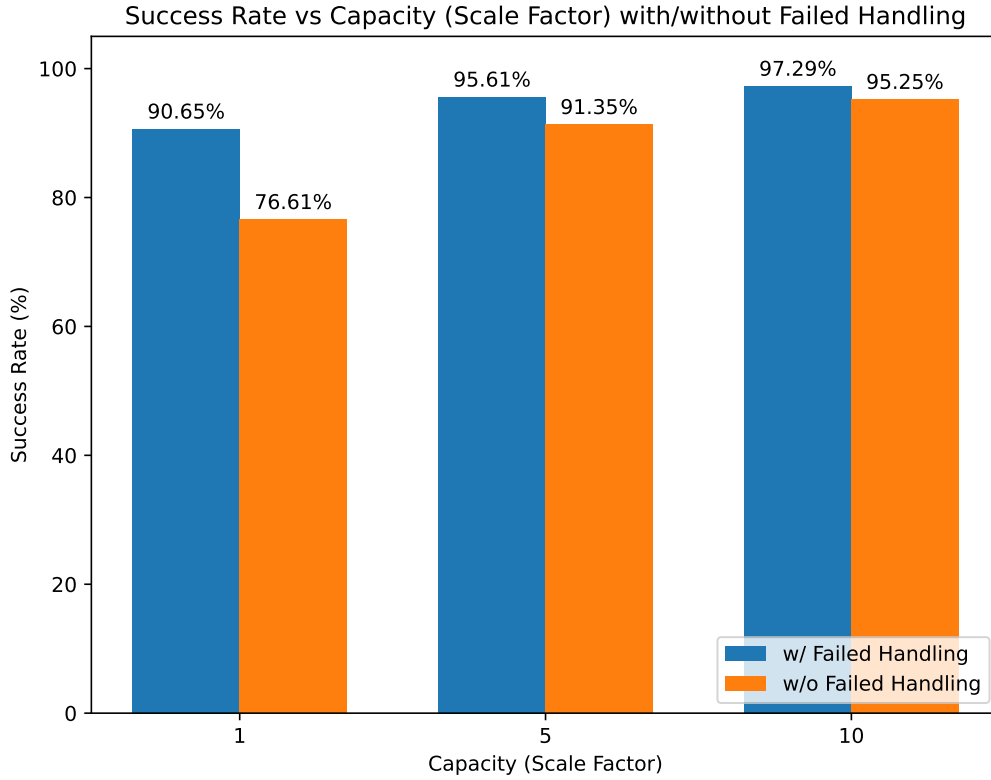


Figure 5.7: Success rate with and without failed handling mechanisms.

5.4 Performance with Failed Handling Mechanisms

The experiment was designed to verify the effectiveness of the algorithm’s second phase, called Phase II: Failed Handling. The experiments with or without Phase II were conducted. The results were subsequently tested under different Capacity Scales.

Figure 5.7 reveals that under smaller channel capacity scale factors, the Phase II: Failed Handling mechanism significantly enhances the transaction success rate. When channel capacity is larger, the improvement in success rate by failed handling becomes less prominent. Most transactions can be completed in the first phase. This experimental result corroborates the findings in Section 5.3 regarding lower transaction delay with larger channel capacity. This outcome is similarly attributed to the increased success rate in the first phase.

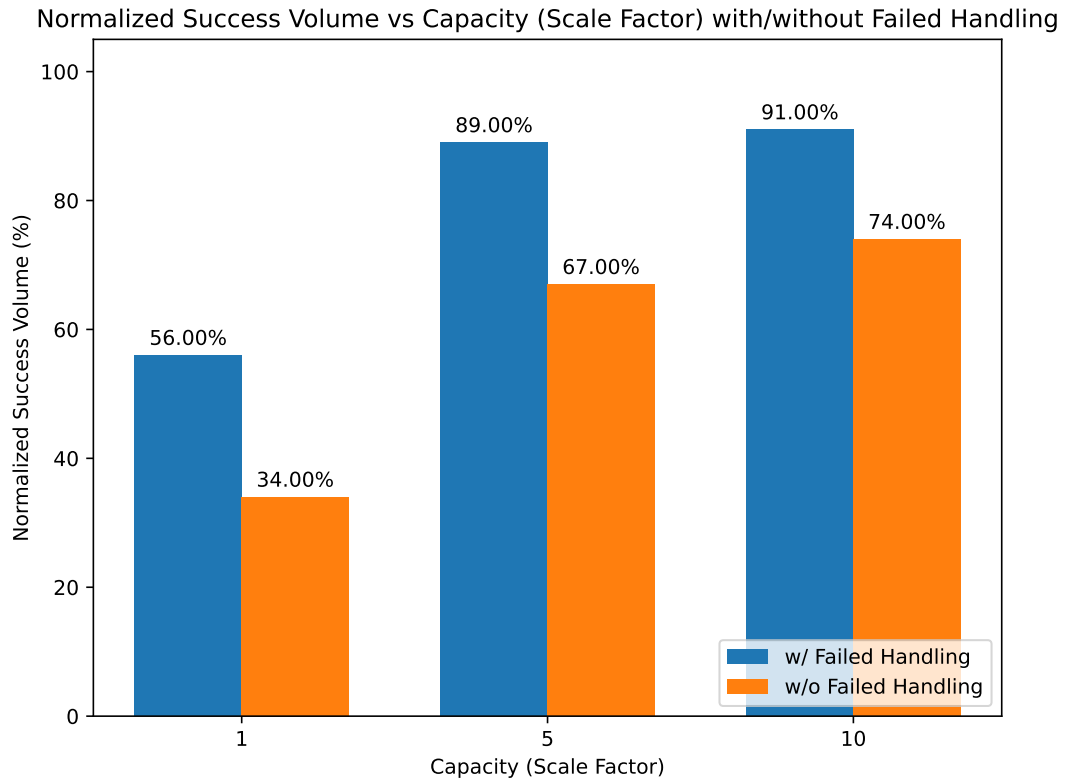


Figure 5.8: Successful volume with and without failed handling mechanisms.

Figure 5.8 demonstrates a significant increase in the total successful transaction volume ratio regardless of the channel capacity. The Phase II failed handling method effectively satisfies large transaction demands and enhances transaction completion rates. The results are achieved by enabling re-attempts based on probing results and intelligently allocating large transaction amounts to available channels.

Chapter 6

Conclusion and Future Work

6.1 Conclusion

This thesis presents a two-phase routing algorithm to improve efficiency and reliability in PCNs. The algorithm consists of an initial payment attempt and a re-exploration phase triggered upon failure. Adaptive responses can be enabled to dynamic or inconsistent network conditions.

Routing decisions are informed by a combination of factors, including channel capacity, balance status, fee conditions, and usage patterns. The integrated approach improves path selection, reduces payment failure rates, and lowers overall transaction costs.

Routing performance was examined based on the simulated transaction workloads and network conditions. The proposed algorithm typically outperforms existing methods in terms of success rate, latency, and cost. The evaluation results confirm the effectiveness of the algorithm for scalable PCN routing.

6.2 Future Work

In this research, it is assumed that channel-related information can be obtained through trusted nodes. Nevertheless, considering the high demands for privacy protection in decentralized platforms, it is imperative that no sensitive data is compromised through any means. Therefore, future work ought to explore the development of more efficient routing mechanisms and also guarantee the privacy of every node.

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